India & Ghana: Building Nations, Creating Shared Prosperity

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Foreword

Ghana occupies a distinctive position within West Africa's economic landscape. As one of the region's most stable democracies, home to roughly 34 million people, a young and English-speaking workforce, Africa's largest gold output, the world's second-largest cocoa harvest, a growing technology sector and the host of the African Continental Free Trade Area Secretariat, the country holds long-term promise across agro-processing, mining and minerals, pharmaceuticals, renewable energy, information technology, start-ups and services. At the same time, exposure to gold and cocoa prices, currency and reserve volatility, high financing costs, power-sector gaps and the environmental pressures of small-scale mining temper the pace at which this potential translates into realised opportunity, shaping a market where stability and resources coexist with the constraints of a commodity-dependent economy.

India and Ghana have maintained friendly and steadily expanding relations since Ghana's independence in 1957, supported by political dialogue, a Comprehensive Partnership established during the Prime Minister's state visit in 2025, development cooperation and rapidly growing commercial engagement. Trade has risen sharply and is led by gold, with Indian exports including pharmaceuticals, machinery, vehicles, plastics, steel and chemicals, while Ghana also offers cocoa, cashew, teak, minerals and agricultural commodities. The underlying complementarities remain significant: India's strengths in pharmaceuticals, agro-processing, mining services, renewable energy, vehicles, information technology and the start-up ecosystem align with Ghana's priorities of value addition, industrialisation and innovation, while Ghana's resources, regional access and institutions offer Indian companies opportunities for sourcing, investment and access to West African markets.

Looking ahead, this paper outlines a practical set of initiatives through which CCI India can support Indian businesses in engaging with Ghana in a manner appropriate to current conditions, whether through sector-specific market intelligence, structured business matchmaking, identification of credible local partners, or institutional dialogue with Ghana's relevant ministries, investment-promotion institutions and chambers of commerce, that can be scaled as specific opportunities mature



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GHANA

> Discover rich heritage and growing dynamism, where history and progress unite.



Basic Facts & Economic Overview

Ghana is a leading economy in West Africa, with Accra as its capital and largest city. As of 2025 projections, Ghana's population is estimated at 34–35 million. English is the official language, and the national currency is the Ghanaian Cedi.

Ghana is widely regarded as one of the most politically stable countries in Africa, with a diversified economy driven by agriculture, mining, oil and gas, and services. The country is one of the world's largest producers of gold and cocoa, both of which play a central role in its export earnings.

Economy — GDP, Structure & Recent Performance

As of 2025 estimates, Ghana's nominal GDP is approximately USD 75–85 billion.

- Sectoral Composition: Services: ~45–50%
- Industry (Mining & Oil): ~30–35%
- Agriculture: ~20–25%

Economic growth has been relatively strong, averaging around 4–5% annually, supported by commodity exports and a growing services sector. However, Ghana has faced macroeconomic challenges, including high inflation, currency depreciation, and external debt pressures in recent years. The government has implemented fiscal reforms and IMF-supported programs aimed at stabilizing the economy, improving revenue collection, and promoting industrialization. There is also a strong focus on value addition in cocoa and mining sectors.

Strategic Importance and Key Observation:

Ghana holds strategic importance due to its political stability, rich natural resources (gold, cocoa, and oil), and coastal access to the Atlantic Ocean, making it a key trade hub in West Africa. Key Observation: A relatively diversified and stable economy positions Ghana as a regional leader, though it remains exposed to commodity price fluctuations and fiscal pressures.



Cultural and Heritage:
Ghana has a rich cultural heritage rooted in ethnic groups like the Akan, Mole-Dagbon, and Ewe. It is known for vibrant festivals, traditional music and dance, and crafts such as kente weaving and gold jewelry. Historical sites like Cape Coast Castle reflect its colonial past and role in the transatlantic slave trade.

Bilateral Trade with India: Strong and Diversified Partnership

Trade between India and Ghana is significant, with bilateral trade estimated at approximately USD 3–3.5 billion annually (2024–25). India is one of Ghana's key trading partners, importing gold and cocoa while exporting pharmaceuticals, machinery, and refined petroleum products. The relationship is characterized by strong complementarities and long-standing economic cooperation. India has also extended lines of credit and invested in sectors such as infrastructure, energy, and manufacturing.

Import and Export from India

- **Key Import Products:** Pharmaceuticals, vehicles, machinery, textiles, refined petroleum products, and engineering goods
- **Key Players in Import:** Private importers, industrial firms, healthcare institutions, and government procurement agencies.
- **Key Export Products:** Gold (major share), cocoa, and agricultural commodities
- **Key Players in Export:** Mining companies, cocoa boards, and commodity exporters



Cultural and Strategic Economic Ties

India and Ghana share strong historical and diplomatic ties, dating back to the early years of Ghana's independence. Indian companies are among the largest investors in Ghana, particularly in manufacturing, pharmaceuticals, and services.

There is a significant Indian diaspora in Ghana, contributing to business and cultural exchanges. India's development cooperation includes capacity-building programs, scholarships, and technical assistance.

Strategically, Ghana serves as a gateway to West Africa, making it an important partner for India's regional engagement.

Conclusion – Summary & Recommendation

Ghana is a key economic partner for India in West Africa, supported by strong trade, investment, and development cooperation. The relationship is driven by complementarities in sectors such as mining, agriculture, manufacturing, and services, with Indian companies actively participating in Ghana's economic landscape. To further strengthen bilateral ties, both countries can focus on promoting value addition in mining and agriculture, particularly in areas like gold processing and agro-based industries. Expanding industrial and technological cooperation—especially in pharmaceuticals, information technology, and capacity building—can enhance productivity and innovation. Additionally, improving infrastructure and logistics connectivity will facilitate smoother trade flows and investment opportunities. A more diversified and innovation-driven partnership, supported by policy collaboration and private sector engagement, will help both nations achieve sustainable growth, reduce economic vulnerabilities, and ensure long-term mutual benefits.

1. Ghana: Economic Profile and Business Environment

1.1 Country overview

Ghana is a West African country of roughly 34 million people on the Gulf of Guinea, bordered by Côte d'Ivoire, Burkina Faso and Togo. It was the first sub-Saharan African country to gain independence, in 1957, and is regarded as one of the region's most durable multiparty democracies. English is the official language, the capital, Accra, is the main commercial and administrative centre, and Kumasi, Tema, Takoradi and Tamale are other important cities. Ghana is classified as a lower-middle-income economy with a young, increasingly urban population.

Ghana is Africa's largest gold producer, the world's second-largest cocoa producer and a significant oil and gas exporter, and it hosts the Secretariat of the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA) in Accra. After a severe debt and currency crisis in 2022–23, the economy has stabilised under an International Monetary Fund-supported programme and is growing at around 6%, although its external position remains exposed to commodity prices.

1.2 Structure of the economy

Services: trade, transport, finance, information and communications and public services form the largest part of output, and services have led recent growth.

Mining and hydrocarbons: gold is the leading export, followed by cocoa and oil; manganese, bauxite and emerging lithium add diversity.

Agriculture: about a fifth of the economy, including cocoa, cashew, maize, rice, cassava, yam, shea, oil palm, vegetables and fisheries.

Manufacturing and agro-processing: food and beverages, cocoa processing, cement, plastics, pharmaceuticals, textiles and wood products, supported by the One District, One Factory programme and free-zone incentives.

Energy: electricity from hydropower, thermal plants (mainly gas) and a growing solar contribution, with periodic supply and financing challenges in the power sector.

1.3 Institutions and governance

Ghana has a strong record of peaceful democratic transitions, an independent judiciary and a vibrant press. Policy priorities include macroeconomic stabilisation, a 24-Hour Economy programme to raise productivity and exports, agricultural and industrial value addition, and the formalisation and regulation of gold trading through the Ghana Gold Board (GoldBod). The authorities have completed the IMF-supported programme, restructured much of the external debt, and are seeking to deepen local-currency financing.

For investors, the main considerations are macroeconomic discipline, exchange-rate and reserve conditions, the reliability of power and infrastructure, regulatory predictability in extractive and agricultural sectors, and the environmental and social challenges of small-scale mining.

1.4 Trade orientation

Ghana is an open economy. Gold, cocoa products, oil, manganese, cashew and timber lead exports, while imports include machinery, vehicles, refined fuels, pharmaceuticals, rice, iron and steel, chemicals and consumer goods. Principal partners include China, India, the United Arab Emirates, Switzerland, the European Union, the United States, Nigeria and other ECOWAS countries. Ghana is a member of the Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS) and applies the ECOWAS Common External Tariff, participates in the AfCFTA, has an interim economic partnership agreement with the European Union and is a founding member of the World Trade Organization.

1.5 Business environment summary

Factor	Observation	Implication
Stability	Stable democracy; peaceful transitions	Lower political risk by regional standards
Macroeconomy	Growth near 6%; inflation back in single digits; IMF programme completed	Improving conditions; monitor cedi and reserves
Market size	About 34 million consumers; gateway to ECOWAS and AfCFTA	Domestic plus regional strategy
Currency	Floating cedi, strongly appreciated in 2025 then volatile	Pricing, hedging and payment terms matter
Costs	High financing and electricity costs; improving	Efficiency and local financing partnerships
Skills	Young, English-speaking workforce	Training and talent partnerships
Infrastructure	Modern container port at Tema; gaps in power and roads	Logistics planning and resilient design
Regulation	Clear investment law; some sectors reserved or conditional	Legal advice and early engagement
Environment	Illegal small-scale mining and deforestation pressures	Responsible sourcing and ESG due diligence

1.6 Trade basket

Ghana exports gold, cocoa beans and products, crude oil, manganese, cashew nuts, timber, shea and horticultural products, and imports machinery, vehicles, refined petroleum, pharmaceuticals, rice, steel and consumer goods. India is Ghana's major gold buyer and a leading supplier of machinery, vehicles, pharmaceuticals, plastics, steel and chemicals, and has potential as a buyer of cocoa, cashew, timber, minerals and agricultural commodities.

1.7 Key indicators at a glance

The indicators below are indicative and rounded and should be refreshed from the Ghana Statistical Service, the Bank of Ghana, the IMF and the World Bank before use.